1. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to establish strict, standardized operational guidelines for the deployment, use, segregation, and sanitation of service and cleaning towels within the facility. This policy mitigates the risk of biological, chemical, and physical cross-contamination, ensuring alignment with municipal health regulations, industrial food safety standards (HACCP), and institutional hygiene benchmarks across all Imperial Kitchen Group Inc. properties.

2. Scope

This policy applies universally to all personnel at Imperial Kitchen Group Inc.—including Front of House (FOH) employees, Back of House (BOH) employees, stewarding/server employees, facilities maintenance, and management. It governs every designated area of operation where towels are utilized for drying, cleaning, or sanitization tasks, spanning food preparation zones, dining rooms, bar service stations, warewashing areas, and public or staff restrooms.

3. Responsibilities

3.1. Supply Chain Management (SCM)

Shall be primarily responsible for the end-to-end management of operational supplies to ensure seamless daily workflows. Their core duty involves procuring and maintaining an optimal inventory of high-quality, color-coded microfiber and cotton towels. By closely monitoring stock levels and supplier quality, they proactively prevent resource scarcity and operational lapses, ensuring that the staff always has the necessary materials on hand to maintain safety and cleanliness standards.

3.2. Learning & Development (L&D)

Shall be focused on workforce education and protocol alignment across the entire organization. They are responsible for facilitating mandatory onboarding for new hires and coordinating recurring quarterly training sessions for all employee levels. These educational programs are specifically designed to reinforce strict color-coding protocols and chemical sanitization guidelines, ensuring that every team member remains knowledgeable and compliant with safety procedures.

3.3. Quality Assurance (QA)

Shall be responsible for enforcing operational standards and maintaining accountability throughout the facility. They conduct mandatory compliance audits to monitor daily practices and ensure all safety protocols are being followed. In the event of visual deviations or a failure to maintain the chemical log, this team is responsible for immediately issuing and managing corrective action plans to swiftly resolve the issues.

3.4. Restaurant & Shift Managers

Shall be tasked with enforcing strict operational discipline in the guest or dining area, kitchen, ensuring that line cooks, preparation employees, and stewards use only the assigned towel color for specific tasks. Additionally, they must verify that sanitizing solution buckets are prepared to exact parts-per-million (PPM) specifications at the start of every shift and refreshed every two hours, or as frequently as the organic load demands.

3.5. Back of House (BOH) Employees

Shall strictly adhere to the designated color codes for food contact surfaces and general prep line duties. They are expected to immediately discard any towel that falls to the floor, comes into contact with raw animal proteins, or becomes visibly soiled by placing it directly into the appropriate designated dirty linen bin.

3.6. Front of House (FOH) Employees

Shall be required to utilize only designated FOH towels for guest-facing surfaces, ensuring absolutely no crossover with BOH towels or chemical-intensive cleaning tools occurs. They must also maintain service stations and guest tables using the discrete, clean deployment of towels, keeping them out of direct sight of patrons whenever possible.

3.7. Sanitation Employees

Shall be responsible for executing the daily collection and segregated laundering of towels according to prescribed chemical and thermal guidelines. Finally, they must meticulously inspect all laundered towels for structural degradation, persistent staining, or tearing, sorting out any defective textiles for immediate discard or down-cycling.

4. Principles

4.1. Color-Coding Matrix

To preserve absolute sanitation integrity, Imperial Kitchen Group Inc. operates on a fundamental segregation framework. Towels must never be multi-purposed across different environmental categories or departments.

The following color classification system is absolute and mandatory. No alternative uses are permitted under any operational circumstances:

Towel Color	Designated Area / Use Case	Operational Specifications & Constraints
White	**Wares**	Reserved exclusively for handling, polishing, or drying clean, sanitized smallwares, glassware, cutlery, and cooking utensils. Must never contact raw food or uncleansed surfaces.
Yellow	**Handwashing Area**	Strictly for dedicated employee handwashing sinks. Used solely for drying clean hands or wiping down the immediate perimeter of the handwash sink basin.
Blue	**FOH (Front of House)**	Utilized for guest-facing areas, including dining tables, host stands, bar counters, booths, and

		service ledges. Maintained in a clean, professional state.
Green	**Kitchen & Prep Lines**	Dedicated to general BOH environments, hot line stations, prep tables, and cutting boards. Separate towels within this color must be rotated when shifting from vegetable prep to allergen-sensitive zones.
Red	**Restroom**	Strictly confined to restroom facilities for cleaning sinks, fixtures, or vanity surfaces. Under no circumstances may a red towel leave the restroom perimeter or enter food/beverage zones.

Table 1. *Towel Color Coding and Designated Area*

Note: Cross-contamination occurs instantly when a towel crosses its zone. A single incident of a Red (Restroom) towel or Green (Kitchen) towel being introduced to White (Wares) or Blue (FOH) environments constitutes a major health code breach and will result in immediate disciplinary action.

4.2. Storage and Handling Procedures

- **Clean Storage:** Clean towels must be stored in designated, elevated, covered plastic bins or dedicated linen shelving completely isolated from dirt, moisture, and chemical storage areas.
- **In-Use Submersion:** All towels actively used for wiping down surfaces must be fully submerged in an approved sanitizing solution between instances of use. Towels must never be left lying on counters or draped over aprons/shoulders.
- **Soiled Accumulation:** Soiled towels must be dropped directly into color-matched or clearly labeled linen bins. Bins must remain covered with a tight-fitting lid to minimize ambient moisture and odor.

4.3. Laundering and Sanitization Standards

- Towels must be laundered completely separate from general uniforms, aprons, or heavy floor mops to avoid fiber degradation and grease transfer.
- Manually scrub the towels using an industrial detergent in warm water (comfortably within safe handling limits, around **45°C to 50°C**). Heavy-duty rubber gloves must be worn to protect skin from industrial chemical exposure. Thoroughly rinse the towels in clean water to completely remove all detergent and loosened organic soil before moving to the disinfection step.

- Submerge the rinsed towels in a dedicated, static hot water bath reaching at least **71°C (160°F)** for a minimum duration of **25 minutes**. Note: Workers must not manually agitate or handle the towels during this high-temperature phase.
- Manually wring the towel using clean, sanitized hands or a manual press. Hang towels completely flat with maximum spacing on dedicated, sanitized drying racks or lines. Drying must take place in a well-ventilated, low-humidity environment (utilizing fans or dehumidifiers if necessary) until towels are 100% bone-dry. Leaving residual moisture promotes rapid microbial proliferation during storage.

5. Compliance, Auditing & Enforcement

Adherence to this Towel Management Policy is mandatory for safeguarding public health and maintaining the brand integrity of the company properties found lagging in standard operational procedures face immediate corrective review.

5.1. Monitoring and Quality Assurance Audits

- **Daily Shift Inspections:** Shift Managers and kitchen captains will perform walkthrough audits at the start, middle, and end of each shift to ensure proper towel color usage and chemical bucket PPM compliance.
- **Unannounced Audits:** The Quality Assurance / Food Safety Committee will conduct random audits across all operational zones. Visual deviations, improperly stored towels, or expired sanitization buckets will be logged as immediate infractions.
- **Log Maintenance:** Daily Sanitation Monitoring must be filled out every two (2) hours and kept on-site for a minimum of twelve (12) months for review by public health inspectors.

5.2. Corrective Actions

Level of Severity	Nature of Non - Conformance	Disciplinary Action
Minor	Internal process failures that may not directly impact product safety but affect overall efficiency and reputation *(e.g. An employee leaves a blue towel draped visibly on a guest table or host stand in direct sight of patrons instead of maintaining a discrete deployment., fails to fill out the Daily Sanitizer Monitoring)*	**1st Offense:** Incident Report (Written Reprimand) and establishing an official timeline re-training for improvement. **2nd Offense:** A formal corrective action plan is issued by Quality Assurance (QA) **3rd Offense:** Final Warning letter will be given to the employee for continued non-compliance or Suspension without pay (1-2 days) when the employee did not comply after the final warning letter and to QA corrective action.

Major	Deviation from internal or contractual quality standards *(e.g. An employee leaves green kitchen towel lying flat on a prep table or draped over their apron/shoulder instead of keeping it fully submerged in the designated sanitizing solution between uses; An employee accumulates soiled towels in an uncovered or improperly labeled bin, allowing ambient moisture and odors to escape.)*	**1st Offense:** Incident Report (Written Reprimand) and establishing an official timeline re-training for improvement. **2nd Offense:** A formal corrective action plan is issued by Quality Assurance (QA) **3rd Offense:** Final Warning letter will be given to the employee for continued non-compliance or Suspension without pay (2-3 days) when the employee did not comply after the final warning letter and to QA corrective action.
Critical	Failing to meet regulatory requirements, such as those outlined by the Food Safety Act of 2013 (RA 10611), and Code on Sanitation (PD No. 856) *(e.g. A red towel (restroom) or green towel (kitchen) is introduced into a white towel (Wares) or Blue towel (FOH) environment, according to the policy that crossing these zones causes instant cross-contamination and constitutes a major health code breach.)*	**1st Offense:** Immediate Incident Report (Written Reprimand) and formal corrective action plan is issued by Quality Assurance (QA). **2nd Offense:** Final Warning, Suspension without pay (3-7 days) or leading directly to Termination.

6. Change History

Revision No.:	Revision Date:	Author & Position:	Purpose of Revision
0	May 22, 2026	Celine Joy Sanchez, **QA Specialist**	Originator
1	June 25, 2026	Celine Joy Sanchez, **QA Specialist**	• Revised the Corrective Action • Revised the Laundering and Sanitization Standards

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